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Acacia podalyriifolia

Acacia podalyriifolia is a perennial tree which is fast-growing and widely cultivated. It is native to Australia but is also naturalised in Malaysia, Africa, India and South America. Its uses include environmental management and it is also used as an ornamental tree. It is very closely related to *Acacia uncifera*. It grows to about 5 m (16 feet) in height and about the same in total width.[2] It blooms during winter.

Common names for it are **Mount Morgan wattle**, **Queensland silver wattle**,[1] **Queensland wattle**, **pearl acacia**, **pearl wattle** and **silver wattle**.[3]

Acacia podalyriifolia	
Scientific classification	
Kingdom:	Plantae
Clade:	Tracheophytes
Clade:	Angiosperms
Clade:	Eudicots
Clade:	Rosids
Order:	Fabales
Family:	Fabaceae
Subfamily:	Caesalpinioideae
Clade:	Mimosoid clade
Genus:	*Acacia*
Species:	***A. podalyriifolia***
Binomial name	
Acacia podalyriifolia A.Cunn. ex G.Don, 1832	

Description

Acacia podalyriifolia is a tall shrub or small tree that typically reaches a height and width of around 2 to 6 m (6 ft 7 in to 19 ft 8 in).[4] Like most species of *Acacia*, it has phyllodes rather than true leaves.[5] It has grey, smooth or finely fissured bark with terete and hairy branchlets that are often covered with a fine, white powdery coating. The silver-grey to grey-green phyllodes have a broadly elliptic to ovate shape and a length of 2 to 5 cm (0.8 to 2.0 in) and a width of 10 to 25 mm (0.4 to 1.0 in). They have hairs on margins and a prominent midvein. *A. podalyriifolia* blooms throughout the year producing simple inflorescences in groups of 8 to 22 along an axillary raceme with an axis length of 2 to 11 cm (0.8 to 4.3 in). The spherical flower heads have a diameter of 5 to 8 mm (0.2 to 0.3 in) and contain 15 to 30 bright golden flowers.[4]

Taxonomy

The species was first formally described by the botanist George Don in 1832 as part of the work *General History of Dichlamydeous Plants*. It was reclassified as *Racosperma podalyriifolium* by Leslie Pedley in 1987 then transferred back to genus *Acacia* in 2014. Other synonyms include *Acacia podalyrifolia*.[6]

Distribution

In Australia it is endemic to parts of southeastern Queensland[5] and the northeast of New South Wales in areas to the north of Legume, but has become naturalised further south,[4] where it is found in open woodland or forest communities.[5] It has also become naturalized in Western Australia and South Australia.[3]

Outside of Australia, it is naturalized in southern and eastern Africa, some parts of the Indian Subcontinent and Southeast Asia, on some Indian Ocean islands, in New Zealand, Brazil, Argentina, and southwestern USA. Overall, it thrives in subtropical and tropical conditions and tolerates semiarid climates.[3]

As a weed

Range of *Acacia podalyriifolia*

Synonyms[1]

- *Acacia fraseri* Hook.
- *Acacia podalyriaefolia* A.Cunn.
- *Acacia podalyriaefolia* A.Cunn. var. *viridis* Guilf.
- *Acacia podalyriifolia* Loudon
- *Acacia podalyriifolia* G.Don var. *typica* Domin
- *Acacia podalyriifolia* G.Don var. *viridis* Guilf.
- *Racosperma podalyriifolia* (G.Don) Pedley
- *Racosperma podalyriifolium* (G.Don) Pedley

Being fast to spread, it is considered an environmental weed in New South Wales, Victoria, Southern Australia, and Western Australia.[3] It is relatively widespread in South Africa, where it is considered a "potential transformer" of natural vegetation due to the possibility of it replacing indigenous vegetation.[3]

Gallery

Acacia podalyriifolia seedpods

Foliage

A. podalyriifolia is conspicuous by its glaucous foliage, 7th Brigade Park, Chermside, Queensland.

A. podalyriifolia in bloom

Inflorescences

Seedpods – MHNT

See also

- List of *Acacia* species

References

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6. "*Acacia podalyriifolia* A.Cunn. ex G.Don" (https://bie.ala.org.au/species/https://id.biodiversity.org.au/node/apni/2921020#names). *Atlas of Living Australia*. Global Biodiversity Information Facility. Retrieved 25 July 2020.

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